

# Chris Tham

Strategy Consultant | Technology Strategy, Architecture and Business Change

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## PROFILE

Founder of Hello Tham, a boutique strategy consulting company. Available for short to medium term consulting engagements spanning strategic business change, business and operating model design, business process improvement, and technology strategy, architecture and solutions.

## KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Flexible strategic change agent and thought leader** — I have facilitated business and technology strategic change for three decades – from Head of Strategy positions at MLC, NAB and ING to delivering IT strategies, roadmaps and operating models as a consultant to Transfield Services and Transport for NSW (through my consulting company Hello Tham).
- Successful and proven technology strategy and architecture leader** — I have built successful architecture practices at organisations from MLC (where I wrote my own job description and built a practice that became a case study at international conferences) to NAB, ING and Broadspectrum. I have provided enterprise architecture advice as a consultant to Transport for NSW and currently at Cochlear.
- Recognised technology innovator and industry expert** — I have been involved in new technologies for my entire career, from early beginnings managing one of Australia's first commercial UNIX systems at Bain & Co (and also one of the earliest non-academic organisations to be on the Internet), to a patented service-oriented advice platform my team pioneered at MLC, to using a large language model to classify support calls in 2018, long before ChatGPT. Most recently I shaped Cochlear's AI strategy. I teach Information Systems at Torrens University, and have written *AI-dō*, a book on using AI effectively.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Enterprise Architect (Consulting)** 2025 – Present  
Cochlear

- Enterprise architecture within Technology & Data Solutions, improving enterprise coherence across federated business domains while enabling faster, safer delivery through reusable architecture services, live architecture repositories, governed AI patterns and measurable architecture value.
- Developed enterprise architecture service models, reusable architecture deliverables and assurance practices across advisory, planning and solution architecture services.

**Learning Facilitator** 2024 – Present  
Torrens University Australia

- Lecturer in Information Systems in the School of Business, teaching undergraduate and masters students.
- Awarded the Learning and Teaching Merit Award twice, with perfect student satisfaction scores in end-of-trimester student evaluation surveys.

**Principal Consultant and Director** 2016 – Present  
Hello Tham

- Founder and director of a boutique consultancy spanning business and IT strategy, enterprise architecture, operating models, strategic roadmaps, analytics and data science, digital products and content platforms.
- Author of *AI-dō: The Way of AI*, and developer of *FinvestLens* and *HelloNotes*, two native Apple applications published as free software.

## Earlier career

**Principal Consultant** Transport for NSW 2016 – 2019

**Strategy Consultant / Executive Manager** Broadspectrum 2011 – 2016

**Consultant** Thorogood & Associates 2011

**Head of Strategy and Architecture** ING Australia 2008

Earlier roles at NAB Group, MLC, Hewlett Packard, AT&T Global Information Solutions (NCR), State Bank Victoria, Optech International, Bain & Company, University of Sydney.

## EDUCATION

**Master of Applied Finance** Macquarie University 1994

**Graduate Diploma** Securities Institute of Australia 1992

**Bachelor of Science (1st Class Honours and University Medal)** University of Sydney 1983 – 1988

## CORE COMPETENCIES

|                     |        |                          |        |
|---------------------|--------|--------------------------|--------|
| Autonomy            | ●●●●●○ | Influence                | ●●●●●○ |
| Complexity          | ●●●●●○ | Learning and development | ●●●●●○ |
| Creativity          | ●●●●●○ | Problem-solving          | ●●●●●○ |
| Improvement mindset | ●●●●●○ |                          |        |